

## A

## Different crimes

A **crime** is an activity that is wrong and not allowed by law. A person who **commits a crime** is a **criminal**.

| crime                                                                                     | person          | verb                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>theft</b> [stealing something, e.g. a car]                                             | <b>thief</b>    | <b>steal/take</b> (something)                     |
| <b>robbery</b> [stealing from a person or place, e.g. a bank]                             | <b>robber</b>   | <b>rob</b> (someone, a place)                     |
| <b>burglary</b> [getting into a building, usually someone's home, and stealing something] | <b>burglar</b>  | <b>steal</b> something<br><b>burgle</b> (a place) |
| <b>murder</b> [killing someone]                                                           | <b>murderer</b> | <b>murder</b>                                     |

Someone's **stolen/taken** my handbag.  
I don't know who **robbed** me.  
Our flat was **burgled**, but they only took money.

There's been another **burglary** in the area.  
Did you hear about the **bank robbery** yesterday?  
Do they know who **murdered** the boy?

## B

## Reporting crimes in the media

**Two women robbed a jeweller's shop in West London early this morning. They **broke in**<sup>1</sup> around 7 o'clock and stole jewellery **worth**<sup>2</sup> over £10,000.**

<sup>1</sup> entered the building using force, e.g. broke a window

<sup>2</sup> with a value of

## BREAKING NEWS

**Detectives**<sup>5</sup> **arrested**<sup>6</sup> a man this morning in connection with the murder of shop assistant, Tracey Miles.

→ [Read full story](#)

The two men **attacked**<sup>3</sup> Mr Crawford while he was walking home yesterday afternoon. Police say the two men hit him in the face several times, then took his money and **escaped**<sup>4</sup> through Bushy Park.

<sup>3</sup> used physical violence to hurt him

<sup>4</sup> left the place to avoid danger; *syn* **got away**

<sup>5</sup> police officers who try to find information to solve crimes

<sup>6</sup> If you *arrest* someone, you take them to the police station because you believe they committed a crime. That person is then **under arrest**.

## C

## Punishment\*

If you commit a crime and the police **catch** you [find you and arrest you], you will be **punished**. For **minor offences** [crimes that are not very important; *opp* **serious**], the punishment may only be a **fine** [money you have to pay], but for serious crimes, you will have to go to **court**. If you are found **guilty** [the **judge**, or a **jury** of 12 people, decides you committed the crime; *opp* **innocent**], you may be sent to **prison** (*syn* **jail**).

judge



court



prison

\* what a person must suffer if they do something wrong

English Vocabulary in Use Pre-intermediate and Intermediate